

Chapter 5.3

Placarding and marking of cargo transport units and bulk containers

5.3.1 Placarding

5.3.1.1 Placarding provisions

5.3.1.1.1 General provisions

- .1 Enlarged labels (placards) and marks and signs shall be affixed to the exterior surfaces of a cargo transport unit or bulk container to provide a warning that the contents of the unit or bulk container are dangerous goods and present hazards, unless the labels and/or marks affixed to the packages are clearly visible from the exterior of the cargo transport unit or bulk container.
- .2 The methods of placarding and marking as required in 5.3.1.1.4 and 5.3.2 on cargo transport units and bulk containers shall be such that this information will still be identifiable on cargo transport units and bulk containers surviving at least three months' immersion in the sea. In considering suitable marking methods, account shall be taken of the ease with which the surface of the cargo transport unit or bulk container can be marked.
- .3 All placards, orange panels, marks and signs shall be removed from cargo transport units and bulk containers or masked as soon as both the dangerous goods or their residues which led to the application of those placards, orange panels, marks or signs are discharged.

5.3.1.1.2 Placards shall be affixed to the exterior surface of cargo transport units and bulk containers to provide a warning that the contents of the unit are dangerous goods and present hazards. Placards shall correspond to the primary hazard of the goods contained in the cargo transport unit and bulk container except that:

- .1 placards are not required on cargo transport units carrying any quantity of explosives of division 1.4, compatibility group S; and
- .2 placards indicating the highest hazard only need be affixed on cargo transport units carrying substances and articles of more than one division in class 1.

Placards shall be displayed on a background of contrasting colour, or shall have either a dotted or solid outer boundary line.

For dangerous goods of class 9 the placard shall correspond to the label model No. 9 as in 5.2.2.2.2; label model No. 9A shall not be used for placarding purposes.

5.3.1.1.3 Placards shall also be displayed for those subsidiary hazards for which a subsidiary hazard label is required according to 5.2.2.1.2. However, cargo transport units and bulk containers containing goods of more than one class need not bear a subsidiary hazard placard if the hazard represented by that placard is already indicated by a primary hazard placard.

5.3.1.1.4 Placarding requirements

5.3.1.1.4.1 A cargo transport unit or bulk container containing dangerous goods or residues of dangerous goods shall clearly display placards as follows:

- .1 *a freight container, semi-trailer, a closed or sheeted bulk container or portable tank*: one on each side and one on each end of the unit. Portable tanks having a capacity of not more than 3,000 L may be placarded or, alternatively, may be labelled instead, on only two opposite sides;
- .2 *a railway wagon*: at least on each side;
- .3 *a multiple-compartment tank containing more than one dangerous substance or their residues*: along each side at the positions of the relevant compartments. If all compartments are required to display the same placards, these placards need to be displayed only once along each side of the cargo transport unit;
- .4 *a flexible bulk container*: in at least two opposing positions; and
- .5 *any other cargo transport unit*: at least on both sides and on the back of the unit.